1.3 Input

In this lesson

You will learn:

- what devices are used for input.

The user

A person who uses a computer is called the **user**. The user tells the computer what to do.

Everything inside the computer is made of electricity. How can the user put electricity into the computer?

Input devices

The answer is to use an **input device**. An input device takes a user's inputs. It turns them into electrical signals that the computer can understand.

Keyboard

A **keyboard** has keys. Touch a key. The keyboard sends a signal to the computer. It tells the computer which key you chose.



Mouse

A **mouse** can roll about on the desk. The mouse sends a signal to the computer. It tells the computer when it moves. A pointer on the screen moves about.

The mouse has a button. You click the button to make a choice.



Touchscreen

Some devices have a **touchscreen**. A touchscreen is used for input and output. It shows you choices on the screen. You touch the screen to make a choice.



Other input devices

There are other types of input. For example:

- A microphone turns sound into electric signals.
- A camera turns pictures into electric signals.



Activity

What devices are used for input? Draw two different devices. Write the names.

Extra challenge

Draw a device that has a touchscreen. Show yourself in the picture using the touchscreen. What is the name of the device?

Think again

What device can you use to input a song to the computer?

1.4 Joining devices together

In this lesson

You will learn:

➔ how devices are linked together.

The parts of a computer

The different devices that make a computer are called **hardware**.

The devices must be joined together.

- The input devices send signals to the processor.
- The output devices get signals from the processor.

Wired and wireless

The signals can go down wires. The signals go as electricity.

Signals can go without a wire. This is called **wireless**.

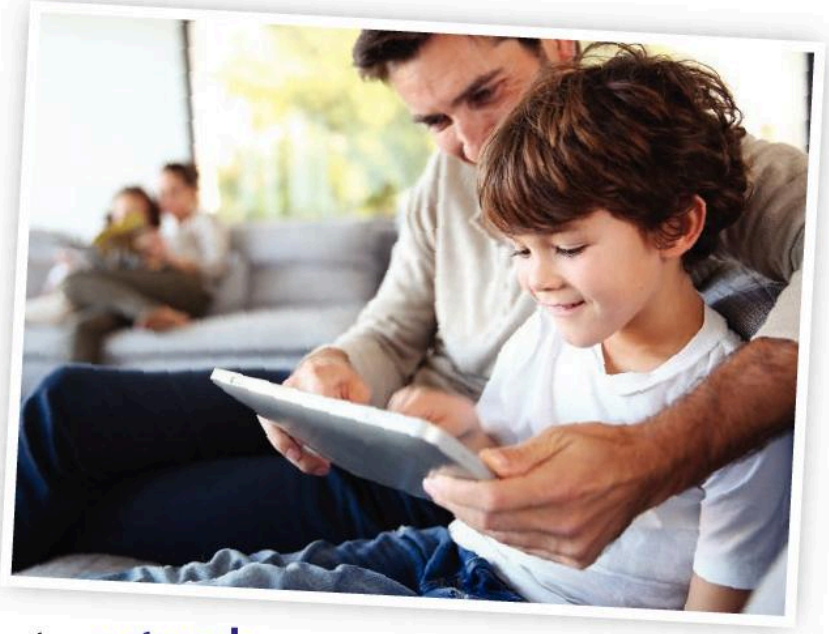




Wireless signals go through the air. They can go as radio signals. Wireless signals are safe for humans.

In the same case

Sometimes the different hardware devices are held inside the same case. The connections are hidden inside the case.



Computer networks

Computers can be joined together. The connections can be wired or wireless.

The computers can send signals to each other. This is called a computer **network**.

The **internet** is a big computer network.



Activity

These pictures show things we can do using computer devices.

Draw a picture of you using a computer. Label the devices. Show the connections.









Extra challenge

Is there a network in your school? Find out more.

Think again

Say a device that has input and output devices in the same case.